

Mobile Watch

A lot has happened in the last month - iPad mini launch, Samsung galaxy SIII Mini launch and much more. Read on

App Watch

This month we take a look at the top apps as far as the Android OS and iOS is concerned

Old web sites, new services

Google Maps underwater, reworked cloud-storage plans, Facebook's gift plans and 1 billion users and other happenings in the web world

The usual Web Watch suspects this month made a number of changes to their products and services, from Facebook to Google to YouTube. Some new services were introduced as well.

There might be some good news for broadband users in India as well, as 9 cities are scheduled to get speeds up to 1Gbps, by mid-2013.

Google round-up

Google has announced a new initiative that is aimed at providing entrepreneurs with online resources and tools to help launch and set up small businesses. The new initiative, called 'Google for Entrepreneurs' is supposed to serve as "the umbrella" for various other programmes and partnerships that support startups and other entrepreneurs. Google's head of Global Entrepreneurship Outreach, Mary Grove, explains that the new initiative mainly focusses on building partnerships with organisations that serve entrepreneurs in local communities, to assist entrepreneurs with Google's teams and tools, and placing relevant Google tools in the hands of startups. Or basically, we're making stuff for people who make stuff so we

can make money off other people making stuff.

While Apple's maps insist the sea is a field or something, Google Maps is going underwater to give you panoramic pictures of reefs. Google released photos of six underwater locations, including Australia's Great Barrier Reef, the Apo Islands and several other coral-filled spots throughout the Pacific. It is part of the Google's World Wonders project, which uses Google's Street View Technology to map lesser known sites across the world. Google has partnered with The Catlin Seaview Survey, a major scientific study of the world's reefs, to make the images available to the users of Google Maps. And unlike Apple, the reefs are where Google say they are.

In other news, google Drive is integrated with Picasa, and you're getting less. Thus far you got 5 GB of free storage with Drive and an additional 1 GB with Picasa. Now, however, you get 5 GB total. Now even though not many use all of that, sad smilies abound whenever you lose something.

Paying customers are also getting screwed! Those of you who paid for Google Drive's additional storage, used to get the free storage + what you pay for. thus, if you paid for 25 GB, you got (5+25) 30 GB of storage. Now all you will get is what you pay for, with the free to everyone storage vanishing.

The spring-cleaning continues with certain services and features



Google for Entrepreneurs, a new service

being discontinued. The ones in the line of fire this time around are - Google News Badges, AdSense for RSS feeds, spreadsheet gadgets, Classic plus (lets users upload custom images for search page) and the Places directory app. The trimming effort now means that around 60 services have already faced the axe, in an effort to make the offerings more streamlined. For more information, refer to Google's official blog post, which you can find by Google searching of course.

Following the introduction of 'Search Plus Your World' that integrated social results into Google Search, Google is now testing the customised search feature for Gmail users, who can now search across a range of Google products from a single search box. Searches will include relevant information from Gmail, and also files, documents, and spreadsheets from Google Drive, which will appear on the right hand side of the results page. Users willing to participate in the trial should

visit the updated field trial page and select 'Join the field trial'.

In a bid to encourage more video uploads from outside the US, Google has added a new set of caption translation tools on YouTube. Google has integrated its Google Translator Toolkit with YouTube Video Manager, enabling support for more than 300 languages. It's notable that these tools should not confused with the automatic caption translator, which YouTube currently supports for about 50 languages. Users who want to add captions in languages that are not supported by the automatic caption translate will have to do the work themselves or ask others to help out.

Google is planning to launch a YouTube pay-per-view service for users in India, according to reports. The move is likely to



YouTube adds more languages

help those poor movie stars and producers poay the rent bills more easily by reducing piracy and also givn consumers a wider range of movies and/or videos to choose from. Google's pay-per-view services are already available in multiple countries such as Australia, Korea and Japan. YouTube's rental model includes a one-time fee to stream the movie for a limited period of time. Google,



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